

OMB Control No: 0970-0114

Expiration date: 03/31/2027

THE PAPERWORK REDUCTION ACT OF 1995 (Pub. L. 104–13)

The purpose of this information collection is the application for CCDF funds and provides ACF and the public with a description of, and assurance about, the States' and Territories' child care programs. Public reporting burden for this collection of information is estimated to average 150 hours per response, including the time for reviewing instructions, gathering, and maintaining the data needed, and completing the form. This is a mandatory collection of information (Pub. L. 113–186), and 42 U.S.C. 9858.

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**Appendix 1: Lead Agency Implementation Plan
for**

State/Territory Texas

FFY 2025 – 2027

Version: Initial Plan

Plan Status: Approved as of 2024-11-09 00:49:24 GMT

For each non-compliance, Lead Agencies must describe the following:

- **Action Steps:** List the action steps needed to correct the finding (e.g., update policy manual, legislative approval, IT system changes, etc.). For each action step list the:
 - o **Expected Completion Date:** List the expected completion date for the action step.
- **Overall Target Date for Compliance:** List date Lead Agency anticipates completing implementation, achieving full compliance with all aspects of the findings. (Note: Compliance will not be determined until the FFY 2025-2027 CCDF Plan is amended and approved).

ELIGIBILITY AND ENROLLMENT:CONTINUITY OF CARE (12-MONTH ELIGIBILITY)

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not always provide a minimum 12-month eligibility period for each child, as required by 98.21(a)(1). (Plan Questions 2.5.2a and 2.5.2c)

Overall Target Completion Date: 01/13/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Board staff members will manually adjust the family's eligibility redetermination date in Texas Child Care Connection (TX3C) when a new child in care results in an extended eligibility period.	01/13/2025
2	All children in families with siblings added to an existing CCS case will have a full 12 months of authorization.	01/13/2026

EQUAL ACCESS:AFFORDABILITY

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not limit all family co-payments to seven percent or less of family income, as required by 98.45(l)(3). (Plan Question 3.1.1a). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for portions of this requirement through January 13, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 01/13/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	TWC will implement new co-payment methodology with the launch of TX3C.	01/13/2025
2	All family co-payments will not exceed 7% of family income.	01/13/2026

EQUAL ACCESS:PAYMENT PRACTICES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not pay all provider types prospectively or alternatively does not demonstrate that it is not a generally-accepted practice for all provider types, as required by 98.45(m)(1). (Plan Question 4.4.1a). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for portions of this requirement through January 13, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 01/13/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Boards will begin paying regulated providers prospectively every two weeks based on enrollment with the launch of TX3C.	01/13/2025
2	All regulated providers (not including relative care providers) are paid prospectively every two weeks based on enrollment.	01/13/2026

EQUAL ACCESS:PROVIDER OPTIONS FOR PARENTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not provide grants or contracts for direct services for infants and toddlers, for children in underserved geographic areas, and for children with disabilities, as required by 98.30(b)(1). (Plan Questions 4.1.1c and 4.5.1i). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for portions of this requirement through April 30, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 04/30/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
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1	TWC Child Care Rules (§809.96) was updated effective July 29, 2024, to allow Boards to contract with providers for direct services for children with disabilities. TWC Child Rules already allowed for Boards to contract with providers for direct services for infants and toddlers and for children in underserved geographic areas.	07/29/2024
2	Develop program parameters for a new statewide initiative to contract for direct services for infants and toddlers, for children in underserved geographic areas, and for children with disabilities.	05/30/2025
3	TWC will update the case management system to allow Boards to manage contracts for direct services.	08/31/2025
4	Implement contracts for direct services for infants and toddlers, for children in underserved geographic areas, and for children with disabilities.	04/30/2026